Collective Bargaining Agreement: Agricultural Industry: Agro Subsector

IT is hereby notified that the Minister of Public Service, Labour and Social Welfare has, in terms of section 80(1) of the Labour Act [*Chapter 28:01*], approved the publication of the Collective Bargaining Agreement set out in the Schedule which was registered in terms of section 79 of the Act.

SCHEDULE

NATIONAL EMPLOYMENT COUNCIL FOR THE AGRICULTURAL INDUSTRY:

COLLECTIVE BARGAINING AGREEMENT: AGRICULTURE INDUSTRY
(AGRO SUBSECTOR)

Made and entered in accordance with the Labour Act [*Chapter 28:01*], as amended from time to time, between the Zimbabwe Agricultural Employers Organisation (ZAEO), Zimbabwe Commercial Farmers Union (ZCFU), Zimbabwe Farmers Union (ZFU), Commercial Farmers Union (CFU) and Agro employer representatives (herein referred to as "the employer parties") of the one part and the General Agriculture and Plantation Workers' Union of Zimbabwe (GAPWUZ) and Horticulture, General Agriculture and Plantation Workers' Union of Zimbabwe (HGAPWUZ) (herein referred to as "the employee parties") of the other part.

The employer parties and the employee parties, being parties to the National Employment Council for the Agricultural Industry in Zimbabwe, have agreed on the following provisions concerning minimum wages in the Agro subsector effective 1st March, 2023.

1. Wages may be paid to employees in the United States dollar or the Zimbabwean dollars.

2. The schedule below provides the minimum monthly wages for the Agro subsector in the United States dollars.

DISTRIBUTED BY VERITAS
e-mail: veritas@mango.zw; website: www.veritaszim.net
Veritas makes every effort to ensure the provision of reliable information,
but cannot take legal responsibility for information supplied.

3. The minimum wages payable to the employees in the Zimbabwean dollar shall be determined by converting the applicable United States dollar minimum wage to the Zimbabwe dollar at the interbank rate prevailing on the twentieth day of the month for which remunerations are due to the employees.

4. The schedule below provides the equivalent Zimbabwean dollar minimum monthly wages for the month of March 2023. The interbank rate used to determine the Zimbabwean dollar minimum monthly wage for March, 2023 is that of 20th March, which stood at **USD: .914.4678**

5. Employers are encouraged to pay the full basic wage or a portion thereof in USD. The recommended portion is at least 30 *per centum* of the basic wage. The USD amount may be paid in cash or into Nostro bank account nominated by the employee for that purpose.

Collective Bargaining Agreement: Agro Subsector of the Agricultural Industry

AGRO SECTOR	FORMER MINIMUM WAGES (SEPTEMBER 2022)	MINIMUM WAGES 20TH FEBRUARY 2023 1USD: 871.1363	MINIMUM WAGES EFFECTIVE 1ST MARCH 2023 CONVERTED AT INTERBANK RATE	MINIMUM WAGES EFFECTIVE 1ST MARCH 2023 [ZWD EQUIVALENT AT INTERBANK RATE OF 20TH MARCH 2023 USD1:914.4678
GRADE	**USD**	**ZWD**	**USD (CONVERTED)**	**ZWD**
A1	107	93 212	118	107 907
A2	114	99 310	126	115 223
A3	124	108 021	137	125 282
B1	134	116 732	148	135 341
B2	142	123 701	157	143 571
B3	156	135 897	172	157 288
B4	167	145 480	184	168 262
B5	182	158 547	201	183 808
C1	196	170 743	216	197 525
C2	212	184 681	234	213 985

NB: Figures have been rounded off to the nearest USD and Zimbabwean Dollar.

Exemptions or Reviews

Establishments or employees may apply to the National Employment Council for exemption or partial exemption/review from paying wages as set up in the above schedule, stating the reasons why that application should be considered, within 14 days of the date of agreement.

Declaration

The Employers and the Trade Unions having arrived at the agreement set forth herein, the undersigned officers of the Council hereby declare that the foregoing is the agreement arrived at and affix their signatures hereto.

Signed at Harare on the 20th of March, 2023.

F. ZONDO,
Chairperson – Employees' Representative.

T. NYIRENDA,
Vice Chairperson – Employers' Representative.

D. MADYAUSIKU,
Chief Executive Officer – NEC Agriculture.